The Next Decision, on One Page

A worksheet for what comes first in your husband's care.

“We have to sort out rehab” is a worry. “The rehab asked for an answer by Friday, and we haven't heard from his doctor yet” is something you can work with.

This page is for one decision only: the one that comes next. Write what you've actually been told, and who told you. Where you don't know something, write “don't know yet” and leave it.

The decision that comes next

A decision is a choice the family has to make. A task is something someone does. Write the choice, in one sentence.

FOR EXAMPLE What we tell the rehab when they call back.

The date you were given, and who gave it

Only a date someone has actually said to you. If the family has been working to a date nobody gave, write “assumed” beside it.

FOR EXAMPLE Friday. The discharge planner mentioned it on Tuesday, in the hallway. I haven't asked whether it's firm.

Why this one comes first

In your own words. Does it have a date? Is something else waiting on it?

FOR EXAMPLE It has the only date anyone has given us. The pharmacy's questions came with no date at all.

What has to be settled before it

What you'd need to know or have in hand before making this choice, one item per line. Beside each, write “settled,” “open” or “don't know.”

FOR EXAMPLE What his doctor expects the first weeks to involve: open. Whether our daughter can be here on the day he leaves: settled, she said yes.

Who can settle each open item

Beside each open item, the person who can answer it: the family, his doctor or nurse, the pharmacist, the social worker or your care consultant. Medical questions go on this list; they don't get answered on this page.

FOR EXAMPLE The first weeks: his doctor. I'll ask at rounds tomorrow. The pharmacy's questions: our son offered to phone them back.

What isn't part of this decision

The chores and the other decisions that got tangled up with this one. Park them here so they aren't lost.

FOR EXAMPLE Picking up his glasses from the house is a task. Most of our daughter's list has no date on it yet.

What this shows you

Three things: the one decision that comes next, the date you were actually given for it, and what still has to be settled first. It doesn't show what the decision should be, or the order of everything after it. Nothing here adds up to a score, and the medical questions go to the people who know his situation.

Ready for the next step?

You've put one decision on paper, with its date and what it's waiting on. The care interview covers the rest: it walks you through your husband's situation area by area, so the decisions that follow rest on the whole picture, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›